REP-106 · From here to a live release: how the game should play, a ladder to climb, and a single-player mode

Game	Fruit Market 1.19.1 live; rules version 18 on the working branch (not released)
Report date	2026-11-12 03:13 (Asia/Kuala_Lumpur)
Type	Proposal
Request	Owner, 2026-11-12: "lets work on publishing this live on the website run through with me your desired workflow for this game from start until finish, anything to be improved, work on getting a smooth animation while keeping the boardgame element in tact"; "go through all the achievements and help to build a coherent system with unlockable cosmetics, create an exciting progression-ish systems to be hooked" think of maybe potentially monetising later down the road"; "go through the other 2 game modes and help to think of having a killer single player mode to keep players hooked, i feel the other 2 modes doesnt provide anything"
Approval	Nothing here is approved or built. The home screen choice (DEC-097) is the only decision already made. Publishing needs its own go-ahead.

This report rests on three studies made by helpers and read by me. The detail, the code references and the numbers are in them:

Study	File	Commit	How it was made
Flow and motion	`docs/studio/review-18/FLOW-AND-MOTION.md`	`0d17ccf`	By reading the code. Nothing was played; every length is worked out, not measured on a phone
Progression	`docs/studio/review-18/PROGRESSION.md`	`3ce2805`	Code reading and about 4,700 computer games
Single player	`docs/studio/review-18/SINGLE-PLAYER.md`	`58d85bb`	Code reading and about 32,000 computer games

No figure in this report comes from people playing. I have not re-run the helpers' computer games.

1. The game from start to finish, as I want it to play

The rules do not change. What changes is that every step is shown as a real thing moving on a table that stays put.

Step	Today	Proposed
Opening and home	"Play full screen?" is asked at every opening. Home shows a picture of your shopkeeper that does nothing	Asked once. Home shows today's market, with your goals a swipe away (DEC-097). A paused game shows your table first
Starting	The Daily market and the Market League replace a paused game without asking	Always ask before a paused game is replaced
Morning	The top-up and the inspector's fine are a line of text	Coins travel to or from the stall, and the cash counts up or down

Step	Today	Proposed
Market Day bid	The customer row empties; the panel says "Bid in" before you bid; nobody is shown winning	The row stays. Bids are turned over together. The winner's stake is placed on the order card
Lorry	No lorry is drawn. Fruit flies from a dot, and the box numbers do not change	The lorry drives in and unloads one crate for each fruit into its lane. The numbers count up as crates land
Buying	Numbers change before the fruit moves. Rivals take 9 to 12 seconds, one piece at a time, and a tap barely helps	The piece lifts from its box to your shelf; numbers change as it lifts and lands. A rival's turn is one move of about a second. One tap hurries everything until your next decision
Customers arrive	Swapped in one frame	Walk-in cards turn face up one after another
Stocking	The piece is in the crate before it gets there	It slides from shelf to crate; the crate is carried to the pricing table
Pricing and the bell	The market flashes back for about a second; the table blinks four times	One sheet stays on the table. Your tags turn face down, the bell rings, the crates open stall by stall, then a pause to read
Favoured Trade	The card is never seen being played, and the bell is shown twice	The question sits under the open crates. The card slides to the tied price and stamps it
The rush	The result is given away at the bell: tickets are already ticked and a won favour card is already on your shelf. One card for each fruit, 13 to 20 seconds	Nothing shows before its customer. One card for each customer (DEC-086). Fruit goes to the customer, coins come back, the ticket is ticked then. About 10 seconds. "Skip" always in reach
Evening	"Lights out" must be tapped even when nothing is left to decide	A built upgrade travels to your stall. The evening ends by itself when nothing is left
Night	The customer and rival rows vanish and the table jumps	The rows stay, dimmed. Every piece slides one box along; spoiled pieces tip off
Last day and results	The jam maker's money is never shown. The table is cut to the results	The jam maker's coins arrive. Totals count up, last place first. The winner is stamped. Then what you earned and what is next (section 2)

Time spent watching. A typical day at four stalls holds about 39 seconds of watching today if you never tap. The target is about 21 seconds, and about 5 if you tap through. A 10-day game goes from about 6.5 minutes of watching to about 3.5.

Five rules that keep it a board game.

1. Things travel; they never just appear.
2. The table stays put: lanes, shelf, customers and rivals keep their places all day.
3. Nothing is shown before its moment.
4. Every move ends by itself and can be hurried with a tap.
5. Only position, size and fade are animated. No new library.

Why it feels cut today. When the Market Ticket look was added, its stylesheet switched off the older fades and slides. Most panels now swap in one frame.

Three things I will assume unless you say otherwise. The 21-second target. The rush moves on by itself about a second after each customer, and a tap moves on sooner. A rival's whole buying turn is shown as one move.

Repairs that come first. Read from the code and to be checked on a phone: "Skip" may be unreachable while a rush card is up; with reduced motion the open crates show for 0.15 seconds; the solo browser test does not know the Favoured Trade step and would not fail if it got stuck there.

2. A ladder to climb: the stamp book

What is wrong today.

- There are 43 achievements, 31 looks and 8 stall colours, but nothing adds up to a number that rises.
- Seven achievements cannot be earned, or almost never, under rules 18. Six looks sit behind them.
- The 14 stall looks and the 8 colours are drawn only inside the Wardrobe, although the screens say rivals see them.
- Online games do not count towards "games played".
- A signed-in player loses trophy progress for any name with a space in it (Uncle Benny, Ah Chen, some customers) at every sync. This is a defect to fix whatever is decided here.

The proposal.

Part	What it is
One number	Your stall level, 1 to 30, shown as a stamp book. A full stamp card raises the level
Stamps	1 for every 3 days played, 1 more for a win, 2 for the first Daily market each day, 10 for the weekly goal, and 2, 5 or 10 for an achievement's Bronze, Silver or Gold step
Six ranks	Roadside Table, Five-Foot Way, Covered Stall, Corner Lot, Shophouse, Towkay. The names are yours to change
Pace	About level 10 after two hours, 17 after ten hours, 30 after fifty. From computer games, not people
Achievements	55 cards with Bronze, Silver and Gold steps. All 43 old ones are kept, so nobody loses anything
Looks with a place	Awnings, shopkeeper looks, signboard frames, titles, price-tag styles, card backs, table themes, bell and coin sounds. The picture and stub card backs you did not choose become rewards
The book	The 36 customer scenes and 21 event pictures fill a collection book: a silhouette until you meet the card
Hooks	A streak that forgives one missed day. One weekly goal. A "next reward" line on the results. No timers, loot boxes, lives or nagging messages

The goals page on the home screen (DEC-097) would show the stamp card, the next reward and the weekly goal.

First version. The trophy fixes; stamps, levels and ranks; the achievement steps that can be read from a finished game; online games counted; the results lines; Trophies redrawn; rewards for levels

2 to 10 that need no new pictures; the looks that exist made visible on the table; the forgiving streak. It touches no rule, no save format and no online message.

Money, later. Nothing is sold now. The study's order: a one-time supporter pack first, then the printed game; no ads; nothing bought ever changes a rule, a price, the odds or what anyone sees. Three small things built in the first version keep that door open without a shop. The game brief still says "no purchases", so selling anything would be a separate decision, and a paid service needs its own approval. The store rules quoted in the study are from general knowledge and must be read again before any sale.

3. A single-player mode: the Market Month

Why the two modes give nothing. Both are an ordinary game with a label.

- The Daily market is a full 10-day game that can be replayed all day on the same shuffle. Its twists only take things away. Its one goal is a board that is empty until others play.
- The Market League is six ordinary games. It stores one number and gives one hat. A Normal computer in the player's seat wins the last stage 17 times in 100, so it ends in a wall.

The proposal (working title: the Market Month).

1. Pick your shopkeeper for the month.
2. A month is four market weeks. A week is a five-day game with one Market Day and a Closing Day.
3. Each week is on a street with a host shopkeeper and a house rule. Week 1 is Village Square. Before weeks 2 and 3 you choose between two streets. Week 4 is the Royal Market.
4. Rent is due every Friday. Your takings go into a savings tin and the rent comes out. When the tin cannot pay, the month is over.
5. Your stall keeps its upgrades and unplayed favour cards from week to week.
6. Finish ahead of the host and you win the host's card and a ribbon.
7. The tin at the end is your score: bronze for finishing, silver at $60, gold at $100.

Street	Host	House rule	Rent
Village Square	Kiki	Calm week: no events	$15
Harbour Steps	Uncle Benny	Festival week: only the busy events	$40 or $46
Old Town	Saleh	Fixed prices	$32 or $38
Spice Lane	Pak Din	Hot spell: heat and shortages	$24 or $30
Grand Bazaar	Rosa	Crowded street: four stalls	$32 or $38
Royal Market	Ah Chen	The big one: four stalls, a Hard host	$42

What it costs. No new rule: every street is made from switches and cards that exist. The rules engine needs one small set-up addition (start a stall with upgrades and cards; build an event deck from chosen cards), with a test that a normal game is dealt and played exactly as before, so the rules version does not change. One new screen and small additions to four. Its own save slot, so it can never replace an ordinary paused game.

Measured with computers. A Normal computer in the player's seat pays all four rents in 90 months of 100; a Hard one in 99. Two tighter rent tables (79 and 66 in 100) are ready if people find it too gentle.

The other two modes. The Market League is folded into the Month: its street names, its place on the home screen and its trophy move across, and nobody loses what they have. The Daily market stays and becomes a five-day market where the first try counts, with a target score to beat. That matters because DEC-097 puts today's market at the top of the home screen.

Risks. Five-day markets and rent have never been played by people. The rent table must be made again after any rules change, including the three balance choices still open from REP-105.

4. The order of work to a live release

I recommend three releases, not one. Putting all of this in one release would hold back rules 18, the new cards and the smoother game for a long time, and would put an untested mode in front of players at the same moment as new rules.

Release	What is in it	Gate before it goes live
A · the next live release	Rules 18 (built). Cards in design A with the new pictures. The screens rebuilt, each with its motion. The text rewrite. The trophy fixes and the first version of the stamp book. The home screen (DEC-097). The two defects (asking before a paused game is replaced; trophy names with spaces). The print kit	`npm run verify:full` PASS; you play the preview; your word to publish
B	The Market Month. The five-day Daily market	Final rules 18 numbers; the rent table re-made; a playtest by people
C	The weekly goal. Card backs and table themes as rewards. The deeper collection book	The usual checks
Later	Measure who comes back. A supporter pack only if the numbers show players returning	A separate decision and approval

Release A in work packages, each checked with `npm run verify` and reported: (1) repairs and the two defects; (2) shared motion blocks and the cards; (3) the screens one beat at a time, the rush first; (4) the text; (5) trophies, stamp book, Trophies, Wardrobe, Results and Home; (6) the print kit and the release preparation.

I give no dates: I have no evidence for how long each package takes.

5. Decisions for the owner

Three now.

#	Decision	Recommendation
1	One big release, or the three releases above	Three releases. This changes your earlier "one release at the end"
2	The stamp book as the progression system, first version in release A	Yes. Rank names can be reworded at any time before it ships

#	Decision	Recommendation
3	The Market Month as the single-player mode, in release B; the League folded into it; the Daily market made five days	Yes, at the gentle rent table

Still open from earlier, to come back to after these three: the three balance choices in REP-105 (Charmer, Ripening Room, mango standing orders), which must be settled before release A is final; tracker 1 or 2 for the print kit; whether Pasar Malam's dark sky should be dark blue; whether a paused game's table comes first on the home screen.

6. Checks

Check	Result
The studies' findings, proposals and decisions read by me (not every code reference checked)	PASS
The trophy-names-with-spaces defect	Confirmed by reading the code: saved sets hold display names such as "Uncle Benny" (`src/ui/achievements.ts:171,178`) and the account clean-up keeps only names without spaces (`src/net/profile.ts:35,48`). Not reproduced in a running game
Their computer games re-run by me	NOT RUN
Anything played by people	NOT RUN
Flow findings checked on a phone	NOT RUN
Game code changed by this report	NOT APPLICABLE: nothing is built